Alexander Dovnar

Cloud & Platform Architect · AWS, OCI, Kubernetes, Terraform

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SUMMARY

Cloud and platform architect with 15 years in infrastructure, 10 of them building production platforms on Amazon Web Services (AWS), Oracle Cloud Infrastructure (OCI), Azure and GCP. Built Runestra, a platform of 62 Terraform/OpenTofu modules, 42 Helm charts and 34 CI workflows that takes an empty AWS or OCI account to production in under an hour instead of 4–8 weeks. Designed observability for ~20,000 gateways across ~60 regions, led AWS-to-OCI migrations, and cut Kubernetes waste with Karpenter. Kubestronaut (all five CNCF Kubernetes certifications) and co-author of "Cracking the Kubernetes Interview" (Packt, 2025). Currently CTO at Naviteq, a 50+ engineer DevOps services company, and still hands-on every week.

SKILLS

Cloud: Amazon Web Services (AWS, expert), Oracle Cloud Infrastructure (OCI), Azure, GCP; cloud migration, multi-account landing zones, FinOps

Infrastructure as Code: Terraform, OpenTofu, Terragrunt, Helm, Helmfile, Ansible, Packer, Vault

Kubernetes & Platform: Kubernetes (EKS, OKE, AKS), Argo CD / GitOps, Karpenter, KEDA, Docker

CI/CD: GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, Jenkins, Renovate, release-please

Observability & SRE: Site Reliability Engineering (SRE), Prometheus, VictoriaMetrics, Grafana, Loki, OpenTelemetry

Security: IAM hardening, secrets management, SBOM / supply chain, Checkov, Trivy

AI Engineering: coding agents (Claude Code, Cursor, Copilot), Model Context Protocol (MCP) servers, agentic workflows

Languages: Python, Bash, HCL

EXPERIENCE

Chief Technology Officer — Naviteq Ltd

Feb 2026 – Present

- Built Runestra, the company's DevOps accelerator, as sole developer, then grew it into a two-engineer product: 62 Terraform/OpenTofu modules for AWS and OCI, 42 hardened Helm charts, 34 reusable GitHub Actions workflows and 6 production-ready stacks (EKS, ECS, OKE). A new client environment goes from an empty account to production in under an hour instead of 4–8 weeks.
- Lead architecture for Oracle-funded AWS-to-OCI migrations; an OCI assessment for an ad-tech client cut projected non-production spend from $64K to $29K a month (−55%).
- Write the high-level designs and estimations for migrations, platform builds and reliability assessments, and review the infrastructure code behind them (one Terragrunt review covered 99 units and 6 OKE clusters).
- Product owner for an AI incident-triage agent that detects, investigates and proposes fixes in Slack, and for an internal library of AI agent skills.
- Own technology direction for 50+ engineers and 20+ active clients; the Head of DevOps and 7 team leads report through me. Authored the company's 60-page engineering standards catalog.

DevOps Team Lead — Naviteq Ltd

Jan 2023 – Jan 2026

- Tech lead on the company's key accounts, from architecture to production, across fintech, ad-tech, security and SaaS; led a team of DevOps engineers.
- Global cybersecurity vendor (SASE platform): architecture and code review for the zero-trust access platform since 2023; designed the observability migration from Prometheus to VictoriaMetrics for

~20,000 gateways across ~60 production regions; wrote the Karpenter upgrade runbook for production EKS.
- Built a cloud-agnostic Kubernetes platform from scratch for a security startup later acquired by GitLab.
- Moved EKS clusters from Cluster Autoscaler to Karpenter, raising node utilization from ~70% to 90%+.

Senior DevOps Engineer — Naviteq Ltd
Jan 2022 – Dec 2022

- One of the company's first engineers: delivered client projects end-to-end and architected highly available, secure AWS infrastructure, cutting costs by up to 40%.
- Standardized reusable Terraform/Terragrunt templates and CI/CD pipelines across teams.

Senior DevOps Engineer — OneSoil
Aug 2021 – May 2022 (consulting)

- Designed a multi-account AWS architecture and built the Kubernetes platform with Prometheus/Grafana observability.
- Reduced cloud costs by ~30% with no loss of performance.

Lead System Engineer — EPAM Systems
Apr 2016 – Aug 2021

- Grew from junior to lead engineer; as tech lead, planned work, assigned tasks and reviewed solutions.
- Designed AWS infrastructure and automated it with Terraform and Ansible; built CI/CD pipelines with GitLab CI and Jenkins.
- Migrated enterprise systems to AWS and Azure for international fintech and retail clients.

Senior Network Engineer — RUE Beltelecom
Mar 2011 – Apr 2016

- Backbone and enterprise networks (VPN, Ethernet, SHDSL) for the national telecom operator; automated network equipment maintenance with scripts.

CERTIFICATIONS

- Kubestronaut (CNCF, 2025), all five certifications active: Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA, 2025–2027), Certified Kubernetes Security Specialist (CKS, 2025–2027), Certified Kubernetes Application Developer (CKAD), KCNA, KCSA
- Earlier: AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Professional (2023–2026), AWS Certified Security – Specialty (2022–2025), HashiCorp Terraform Associate, Cisco CCNA

COMMUNITY & PUBLIC ACTIVITY

- Co-author, "Cracking the Kubernetes Interview" (Packt, 2025, 560 pages; with Viktor Vedmich and Viktoria Semaan)
- Speaker: DevOpsDays Kazakhstan 2024 (talk and workshop), AWS Community Day Almaty 2025 (EKS cost-optimization workshop), DKT Conf 2026 (co-organizer and speaker)
- DevOps Kitchen Talks — co-host (2020–present); 100+ episodes, 300k+ views
- AWS Community Builder (2023–present); Terragrunt Ambassador (2025–present); course author and trainer at Slurm.io (Kubernetes, CI/CD, Terraform)

LANGUAGES

- English (fluent), Russian (native)

EDUCATION

- Engineer's degree, Belarusian State University of Informatics and Radioelectronics (BSUIR), 2015